

Program Concept v2 — full depth, two lanes

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The verdict on v0 and v1

The original syllabus (v0) has the right depth and the wrong delivery; the rebuild (v1) has the right delivery and the wrong depth; the fault in v1 was treating "accessible" as "shorter", when the real fix is to write once at full depth and let the learner choose how far in to go.

Dimension	v0 (original syllabus)	v1 (rebuild)	Keep for v2
Depth and professional appeal	Postgraduate; studio-scale briefs; tools to fabrication level; venture realism	Entry level; 15-hour lenses; tools trimmed to a thread; venture to literacy	v0's depth, all of it, as the Mastery tier of every module
Audience	Designers only, implicitly advanced	Designers plus the people who brief and judge	v1's two lanes
Structure	Six tracks, duplicated tails, no outcomes or hours	Four levels, outcomes and hours, artifact-driven	v1's structure, holding v0's content
Practice areas	Four studios: art, space, object, body	Six lenses, adding identity and digital product	Six areas, each with a lens (Practice) and a studio (Mastery)
Tools	Eleven modules, each a career	One free-tools thread, five electives dropped	Core thread at Practice; the dropped electives restored at Mastery with free tools
Venture and release	Two tracks, 15 modules, near-verbatim duplication	Five short literacy modules	Five modules, Practice as literacy, Mastery as full simulations and a real handover package

Dimension	v0 (original syllabus)	v1 (rebuild)	Keep for v2
Register	Manifesto adjectives, dense, memorable, exclusionary	Plain, sometimes flat	Precise professional vocabulary, no adjectives; the rule in §4
Geography	Gulf, MENA, SWANA as core identity	Global first, region parked	Global spine with a regional slot in every unit; the regional vertical as the first expansion
Delivery	Assumes cohorts, live crits, kits, specialists, budget	Self-paced, AI partner, no budget, free sources	v1's delivery, with the AI partner taking the fabricator, client and stranger roles the studios needed
The artifact	Concept DNA plus anchor, family, dossier	Concept DNA, growing per unit, lane-specific additions	v1's growth model with v0's full dossier at Mastery
Assessment	Critical defence, dossier, live panel	Tests and drift scores, no grades	Both: tests at every depth, a defence at Mastery, still no grades
Method (Track 02)	The strongest part, complete	Kept, lightened, given a data structure	v0's completeness on v1's data structure

What was lost in v1 that mattered. The studio-scale brief (a real site, a real object family, a capsule collection); the invisible systems taught to working depth (back of house, egress, BOM, tolerances, tech-packs); the tool electives; the sense that the program is for people who will actually build; and the regional specificity that made it unlike anything else.

What v0 lacked that v1 supplied. A learner who is not a designer; outcomes, hours and sequence; the artifact as the through-line; free sources; a delivery that works without a room, a budget or a faculty; and two practice areas the industry commissions most.

The combining principle

Write every module once, at the depth of the original, and give it three depths of entry: Orientation (the lab, the vocabulary, one case: enough to see the idea), Practice (the professional content: enough to use and to brief it), and Mastery (the studio-scale brief, the tools, the defence: enough to build and be judged on it); the lanes do not change the content, they change the default depth and the Apply task.

Depth	What it contains	Time share	Who it is for by default
Orientation	The provocation, the lab, the term named after the lab, one case, one short Apply	About 15% of a module	Anyone; the briefer's floor; a taster for makers
Practice	The full concept set, the world set of cases, the method, the make or brief Apply, the partner's Mirror and Stranger	About 45%	Briefers' default; makers' minimum
Mastery	The original's studio material: long-form briefs on a real site, object family, body or brand; tools electives; the invisible systems to working depth; the partner as Fabricator, Client and CFO; the defence	About 40%	Makers' default; briefers who commission at scale

Why this is not dumbing down. The Mastery tier is the original curriculum, complete, in plainer language. Orientation is not a simpler version of it; it is the first fifteen minutes of it, designed so that a non-designer can start. The learner who stops at Orientation has met the real idea, not a cartoon of it.

Lanes on top of depths

	Make lane	Brief-and-judge lane
Default path	Practice through Foundations; Mastery through Method, one studio, the tools core and the defence	Orientation through Foundations; Practice through Method, one lens and the venture modules; Mastery for R3 (briefing and handover)
Apply task	Produce	Write the brief, or judge a supplied piece with the four tests
Artifact	DNA, anchor, adjacent translation, dossier	DNA, brief, judged set, commissioning record
Can they cross?	Yes; any learner may take any depth of any module	

What keeps the professional appeal. The studio briefs at Mastery are the same ones a design master's would set; the world sets are large and global; the tools go to fabrication, capture and analytics; the venture modules run real numbers; the vocabulary is the profession's own; and the regional vertical, when built, gives the program a position nobody else holds. What makes it accessible is only the entry ramp and the removal of adjectives.

The v2 module map

Four levels, 21 modules plus six tools electives; about 45 hours if taken at Orientation, about 200 at Practice with one area, and about 480 at Mastery with one studio, which is between a postgraduate certificate and a diploma in size. Hours are Orientation / Practice / Mastery.

Level 1 — Foundations

Module	Orientation	Practice	Mastery	Hours
F1 Histories of making	The long timeline in nine pivots; the reference-to-appropriation spectrum	Centres and peripheries across the globe; how histories are written; counter-histories; obscured labour; reading an object as history; the attribution and consultation protocol	A counter-history research piece on one lineage from primary sources, with an attribution record; the regional slot filled for the learner's own place	4 / 12 / 16
F2 Form	Archetype DNA, grid, figure and ground, tension labs	Proportion systems across cultures (Islamic geometry, tatami and ken, classical and modular, textile grids, Chinese modular building); typology theory; scale; visual gravity	A typological subversion study built parametrically: one archetype, five subversions, identity kept, with the rule that generates them	4 / 10 / 12
F3 Body and senses	Affordance and colour-interaction labs	The body as metric; cognitive load; colour physics and colour across cultures; light as hierarchy; thresholds and sequence	A full sensory system spec for the learner's world: anthropometric rules, palette and lighting logic, threshold sequence	4 / 10 / 10

Module	Orientation	Practice	Mastery	Hours
F4 Material and meaning	Material-as-text and sign-swap labs	Provenance, lifecycle, patina; semiotics; language and script as structure across writing systems; tone of voice	Material dossier (five materials, lifecycle, meaning, ageing) and a multi-script text architecture	4 / 10 / 10
F5 Systems and consequences	Ecosystem map and futures wheel	Feedback and stocks; non-human actors; lifecycle and planetary weight; scenario methods; what design cannot fix	Scenario set and first planetary ledger for the learner's intervention, with data	3 / 8 / 10

Level 2 — Method (one continuous project)

Module	Orientation	Practice	Mastery	Hours
M1 Research and premise	Synthesis board and perimeter card	Research routes; credibility and bias; synthesis to insight; stance and contradiction; enable, protect, resist, reject, transform; non-goals; research ethics	A two-week field research sprint with archive work and interviews, to a defended World Premise	3 / 10 / 12

Module	Orientation	Practice	Mastery	Hours
M2 Concept DNA	DNA Builder and the four tests on a supplied world	Constants, variables, thresholds; the twelve grammars and choosing among them; anti-DNA; alignment with practice, collection and masterbrand DNA; category obligations; the Stranger test; versioning	Full grammar set written out; three blind-interpretation rounds (peer, agent, both); contributor brief and agent prompt architecture; DNA v1.0 with change log	4 / 14 / 16
M3 World architecture	Collection matrix	Roles; families, series, editions, drops; cross-scale coherence; distribution of cost and risk; pacing and curation; carriers and interfaces	Full collection map with risk and cost distribution, editorial calendar, carrier strategy	3 / 10 / 12
M4 Make and test	Prototype question planner	Choosing practice and anchor; prototype fidelity; the adjacent translation; abandoned directions; revision history; specialist gaps	Anchor expression, differentiated family, adjacent translation, evidence compilation, DNA v2.0	2 / 10 / 30

Level 3 — Practice areas (each a lens at Practice, a studio at Mastery; take one or two)

Area	Orientation	Practice (the lens)	Mastery (the studio, from the original units)	Hours
S1 Space and experience	What a space makes you do	Program before form; choreography; atmosphere; reuse; the invisible systems; plan and section; briefing a spatial designer	The ten units of 3.2 on a real base-build or reuse site: lineage and regional modernisms, programme and scenography, choreography, palimpsest, tectonics, microclimate, urban edge, back of house and life safety, economics, representation and digital twin	2 / 15 / 70
S2 Object and product	What an object makes you do	The object as agent; hand and body; use choreography; cardboard prototyping; making routes; BOM and box; repair; briefing a product designer	The ten units of 3.3: ontology and craft, ergonomics, typology and proxemics, the buck, soft architecture, industrial methods, compliance, cyber-physical, supply chain, circularity; a resolved object family	2 / 15 / 60

Area	Orientation	Practice (the lens)	Mastery (the studio, from the original units)	Hours
S3 Body and wearables	What a garment makes you do	Silhouette and power; motion and ease; textile logic; pattern basics; semiotics of dress; collection matrix; tech-pack; labour; briefing a fashion designer	The twelve units of 3.4: from sartorial history to supply-chain ethics; a capsule with pattern, drape simulation, grading, tech-pack, campaign frame	2 / 15 / 70
S4 Art and installation	What a room does to a work	The container; data to space; scale and site; light and sound; audience and time; documentation; funding; commissioning an artist	The eight units of 3.1: a site-responsive proposal with light and sound simulation, audience rules, decay plan, ecological ledger, funding defence	2 / 15 / 50
S5 Identity and communication (new)	What a mark makes you feel	The brand as world; marks, type and colour as system; tone; grids; multi-script systems; campaign; the design brief	A complete identity system generated from the DNA and stress-tested across ten touchpoints, with guidelines a stranger can apply	2 / 15 / 50
S6 Digital product and interface (new)	What a screen makes you do	Interface as affordance; flows and states; design systems as DNA; content; accessibility; prototyping; the product brief	A working prototype with a design-token system derived from the DNA, an accessibility audit, and a handover spec	2 / 15 / 50

Tools (core thread at Practice, electives at Mastery)

Module	Practice (thread)	Mastery (elective, 12–16 h each)
T1 Seeing and drawing	Gesture, line weight, plan, section, movement notation	Full orthographic and exploded sets of a real assembly
T2 Parametric thinking	One rule, many outputs (p5.js)	Node-based definitions; form-finding by force (Blender geometry nodes; Grasshopper if licensed)
T3 Working with AI	Prompt architecture; agent briefs; drift scoring	Agent teams; workflow architecture; bias and data-sovereignty review
T4 Simulation	A scene, a light, a walk (three.js templates)	Real-time walkthrough; interface prototype; sound design in a DAW
T5 Honest evidence	What a render claims (Blender)	Physically based materials; cinematography; render ethics audit
T6 Reality capture (elective)	—	Phone photogrammetry; point clouds (free tools)
T7 Data visualisation (elective)	—	Parse, encode, spatialise a dataset
T8 Physical computing (elective)	—	Sensor, actuator, behaviour; simulated hardware where no kit (free simulators)
T9 Environmental analytics (elective)	—	Climate simulation and a full LCA (openLCA, free climate tools)
T10 Fabrication (elective)	—	Toolpaths, additive constraints, failure analysis

Level 4 — Venture and release

Module	Orientation	Practice	Mastery	Hours
R1 The world as venture	Orbital map	Brand architecture; community and access; campaign as world extension	Full masterbrand and orbital architecture with rules of engagement; a campaign architecture	2 / 8 / 10
R2 Money, law and rights	Runway simulator	Cash and burn; funding routes; IP taxonomy; attribution as protocol; responses to copying	18-month model with two scenarios; IP and attribution protocol; contract anatomy (literacy, reviewed)	2 / 8 / 12
R3 Making it real	Collaboration matrix	Briefing others; minimum viable implementation; handover packages; specialist orchestration	A complete handover package for the studio project, audited; an MVI negotiation against the partner as fabricator and CFO	2 / 8 / 12
R4 Responsibility	Lifecycle planner	Release, maintenance, repair, end of life; the planetary ledger	The final ledger with data; a repair and end-of-life design for the studio project	2 / 6 / 8

Module	Orientation	Practice	Mastery	Hours
R5 Defence and dossier	A transfer brief in miniature	The transfer brief; the stranger test at scale; dossier curation	A transfer brief under an unfamiliar constraint; a defence with the partner's panel; the professional dossier with abandoned directions and revision history	2 / 8 / 20

Totals. Orientation path about 45 h; Practice path with one area about 200 h; Mastery path with one studio and two tool electives about 480 h. Every module still sells alone at any depth.

Vocabulary policy

Keep the profession's precise terms, because they are the professional appeal and a briefer needs them to talk to designers; drop the manifesto adjectives, because they add heat without meaning; and introduce every kept term by a lab before it is named.

Keep (precise, professional)	Drop (adjectives and intensifiers)	Rename (obscure for its own sake)
typology, morphology, archetype, affordance, ergonomics, proxemics, tectonics, palimpsest, patina, semiotics, grammar, constant, variable, threshold, anti-DNA, anchor, hero, core, carrier, tech-pack, bill of materials, tolerance, egress, back of house, CapEx and OpEx, minimum viable implementation, handover, provenance, lifecycle, attribution	rigorous, uncompromising, brutal, lethal, absolute, obsessive, profound, bulletproof, hyper-, relentless, unglamorous, seductive (as praise), sublime (as praise)	"somatic truths" → the body as metric; "epistemology" in headings → how we know; "ontology" in headings → what an object is; "generative world systems" → method; "orbital architecture" stays but is defined in one line; "Modular" → Module

Rules

1. A term is first met in a lab, then named, then defined in the glossary; it never appears in unit copy before its lab.
2. One term per idea; no synonyms for style.
3. Sentences under 25 words in unit copy; briefs and provocations may be written with more voice.
4. The original's register survives in two places: the provocation that opens a unit, and the studio briefs at Mastery, where a strong voice sets the stakes.
5. Every kept term has a one-line "say it to a designer" note for the briefer lane.

Nine angles to read the curriculum from

The same 21 modules should read as a coherent whole from every angle a learner, a partner or you might take; if one angle shows a hole, the map is wrong, not the angle.

Angle	The question it answers	What v2 shows
By lane	Where does a maker or a briefer spend their time?	Makers: Practice foundations, Mastery method and one studio. Briefers: Orientation foundations, Practice method, one lens, venture; Mastery only in briefing and handover
By depth	What do I get for 45, 200 or 480 hours?	Orientation: the ideas and the vocabulary. Practice: the method and one medium, usable. Mastery: the original program, built and defended
By the artifact	Which section of the DNA does each module fill?	Foundations fill candidates and the perimeter; Method turns them into rules and tests; areas add the anchor or the brief; venture adds rights, handover, lifecycle and the dossier
By medium	I only care about products (or brands, or spaces): what is mine?	One area's lens and studio, plus the tools it needs (S2 needs T1, T2, T5, T10; S6 needs T3, T4); everything else optional
By knowledge type	Is this history, perception, method, practice or business?	Historical: F1, F4, S-lineage units. Perceptual: F2, F3. Method: M1-M4. Practice: S1-S6, tools. Business and law: R1-R5. Each type has its own research plan
By traditional vs innovative	What could be a normal online course, and what needs an interactive or the AI partner?	Roughly 40% traditional (cases, explainers, briefs), 60% innovative (labs, simulators, the partner's three voices, the Stranger test); the studios are the most innovative part because the partner replaces the fabricator, client and crit

Angle	The question it answers	What v2 shows
By geography	Is this a global program or a regional one?	Global spine; a regional slot in every unit's world set; the Gulf, MENA and SWANA vertical as the first expansion, filling those slots and adding regional studio prompts
By career stage	I am a student, mid-career, a founder: where do I enter?	Student: Orientation then Practice in order. Mid-career designer: Practice foundations fast, Mastery method and studio. Founder or brand lead: briefer lane, Mastery in R1-R3
By time budget	I have five hours, a weekend, a quarter, a year	Five hours: one module at Orientation. A weekend: M2 at Practice. A quarter: the Practice path. A year at 10 hours a week: the Mastery path

Holes the angles reveal, and the fixes already in the map. A briefer who wants a studio in identity (S5) has no Mastery path shorter than a maker's; add a commissioning variant of each studio brief. A student with no project cannot run Method; supply three seed worlds. Tools are invisible from the lane angle; show them as a sidebar in every area.

Alternatives

The depth-dial model is the recommendation, but four other shapes are defensible, and one of them (core plus pathways) is closer to how professional programs are actually structured; the table gives each its honest case.

Shape	How it works	Strength	Cost	Suits
A. Depth dials (recommended)	One curriculum, three depths per module, lanes set defaults	Written once; nobody gets a lesser version; every module sells alone; both audiences share cases and labs	Harder to market ("what is it?"); the app must handle depth switching; Mastery content is the bulk of the work	A trial of a repeatable method; a mixed audience
B. Two products	"Foundations and Method" for everyone; "Studios" for makers, sold separately	Clear positioning; the professional product keeps its edge undiluted	Splits the artifact; briefers never see the studios they commission; duplicated marketing	If the first product must launch fast to one audience
C. Core plus pathways	Method is mandatory; learners choose a pathway (an area plus its tools plus its venture units), like a master's with specialisms	Closest to professional education; strong identity per pathway; natural for accreditation later	Less flexible; a briefers must pick a pathway too; more sequencing rules	If the aim is to look like a school
D. Studio-first	Learners enter through a studio brief in week one and are sent to Foundations and Method units as the brief demands them	Highest motivation for makers; learning is pulled, not pushed	Chaotic for non-designers; hard to build (every studio must link back to every foundation unit); needs the whole program before launch	Experienced designers only

Shape	How it works	Strength	Cost	Suits
E. Region-first (the original)	The Gulf, MENA and SWANA vertical is the identity; global material supports it	Unique position; deep cultural authority; strong partners possible	Narrows the audience; the commissioned regional assets are the expensive part and cannot be free; parked by your decision	When budget and regional partners exist

A hybrid worth considering: A with C's pathways as named routes. Keep the depth dials, but publish four named routes through them (Maker, Briefer, Founder, Student) so the marketing question has an answer without changing the structure. Routes are just defaults; the dials stay.

Alternatives inside the map

- Six areas or four? Keeping the original four keeps focus; adding identity and digital product keeps the briefers, who mostly commission those two. Recommended: six, build the original four first.
- Tools as a level of their own, or threaded? Threaded at Practice keeps them tied to use; electives at Mastery keep the depth. A separate tools level reads as a bootcamp and was the original's weakness.
- Method before or after Foundations? Before, for experienced makers (they have a project); after, for everyone else. The dials allow both: Method at Orientation can be taken first as a preview.
- One artifact or two? One DNA for everyone, with lane-specific attachments. Two artifacts would split the cohort's most useful interaction, makers and briefers testing each other.

What v2 changes for research, interactives, the AI partner and the build order

The v1 concept's research plan, free-resource strategy and AI pipeline still hold; v2 adds the Mastery tier, which roughly triples content volume and needs four things v1 did not: studio-scale briefs on free real inputs, larger world sets, long-form interactive patterns, and two more partner roles.

Research. World sets grow from 20–30 to 40–60 objects and cases per module, still from open collections; every unit's set carries an empty regional slot. Studio briefs need a free "site pack": an OpenStreetMap plan and a CC0-documented building for S1, a common object and a public 3D scan for S2, the learner's own body for S3, a public site for S4, an existing public-domain identity to re-world for S5, a well-known flow for S6. Venture modules need the public guides and open templates from v1 plus real formulas in the simulators.

Interactives. The 25 patterns from the analysis all return; three long-form patterns are added for Mastery: a Studio Workspace (the project, its site pack, prototypes, revision history and partner threads in one place), a Handover Auditor that reads a full package, and a Defence Room where the partner's panel questions the dossier. The Stranger test gains a peer mode for the day there are enough learners.

The AI partner. Three voices at Practice (Mirror, Stranger, Client); two more at Mastery (Fabricator: tolerances, materials, what will not build; CFO: what it costs, what to cut). Still no grades. The Fabricator and CFO replace the specialist consultations the original assumed.

Build order (Practice first everywhere, Mastery where it proves the most)

1. Fix the DNA data structure and the site-pack format.
2. Practice tier of Foundations and Method, in full.
3. Mastery tier of M2 and M4 (the spine at full depth).
4. Practice tier of all six areas; Mastery studio for one (S2 Object is the cheapest to do at home and the easiest to test).
5. Practice tier of venture; Mastery of R3 and R5.
6. Remaining Mastery studios and tool electives, one at a time, through the module factory.
7. The regional vertical, filling the slots.

Effort, honestly. At 2–3 days a week with me doing the production, the Practice tier of the whole program is a few months of your review time; each Mastery studio is a month of its own. Orientation comes almost free, since it is the first fifteen minutes of every unit.

Decisions to close v2

1. The shape: depth dials (A), or A with named routes, or core plus pathways (C).
2. The areas: six, or the original four first.

3. Method's place: before Foundations for experienced makers (allowed by the dials), or strictly after.
4. The first Mastery studio to build: S2 Object (recommended), or the one you would most enjoy judging.
5. The register: agree the keep and drop lists in §4, or add to them.

Answer these and I will write the module descriptors for Foundations and Method at all three depths, then the F1 world set and the M2 exemplar DNA as the two proofs.